ZANDER

Operations Playbook

Your Complete Guide to Daily, Weekly, and Monthly Operations

A ZANDER SYSTEMS PUBLICATION

Operating Simply Methodology

$79

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01

Introduction to Operational Excellence

Why systems beat personality every time

Operations Playbook

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The Daily Operations Framework

The Power Hour and daily rhythms

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Weekly Rhythm: The Pulse of Your Business

Monday kickoffs to Friday reviews

1. Introduction to Operational Excellence
2. The Daily Operations Framework
3. Weekly Rhythm: The Pulse of Your Business
4. Monthly Operations Review
5. Standard Operating Procedure Templates
6. Process Documentation Best Practices
7. Metrics That Matter
8. Implementation Checklist

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Monthly Operations Review

The most important meeting of the month

Why Operations Matter

Every successful business runs on systems. Not personality, not luck—systems. The businesses that scale are the ones that can replicate success without the founder touching every decision.

This playbook gives you the exact frameworks we use at Zander to help businesses move from chaos to clarity. These aren't theoretical concepts—they're battle-tested processes from real companies generating real revenue.

The Operating Simply Philosophy

Operations should be **simple**, **repeatable**, and **measurable**. If your team can't explain a process in 30 seconds, it's too complicated. If you can't measure it, you can't improve it.

Who This Playbook Is For

- Business owners drowning in daily tasks
- Managers who want to systematize their department
- Teams ready to work smarter, not harder
- Anyone who says "I don't have time" more than twice a day

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Standard Operating Procedure Templates

SOPs that actually get used

The Power Hour (First 60 Minutes)

Your first hour sets the tone for the entire day. Here's the exact routine:

Minutes 0-15: Review Dashboard

- Check overnight notifications
- Review today's calendar
- Identify the ONE critical task

Minutes 15-30: Team Standup (if applicable)

- What did you complete yesterday?
- What's your focus today?
- Any blockers?

Minutes 30-60: Deep Work Block

- No email, no Slack, no interruptions
- Attack your ONE critical task
- Batch decisions for later

The Daily Checklist

Copy this checklist for every team member:

Checklist

- [ ] Morning Huddle Complete
- [ ] Critical Task Identified
- [ ] Inbox processed (not necessarily empty)
- [ ] All commitments logged in calendar
- [ ] End-of-day status update sent

- [ ] Tomorrow's priorities identified

Communication Windows

Stop the constant interruption cycle:

TIME BLOCK	ACTIVITY
8:00-9:00	Deep Work
9:00-9:30	Team Standup
9:30-12:00	Meetings & Communication
12:00-1:00	Lunch (actually take it)
1:00-3:00	Deep Work
3:00-4:00	Admin & Email
4:00-5:00	Planning Tomorrow

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Process Documentation Best Practices

Write once, reference forever

Monday: Planning & Priorities

The Weekly Kickoff Meeting (30 minutes max)

Agenda:

1. Review last week's wins (5 min)
2. Identify this week's priorities (10 min)
3. Resource allocation check (5 min)
4. Potential blockers (5 min)
5. Commitments and assignments (5 min)

Wednesday: Mid-Week Check-In

A 15-minute pulse check:

- Are we on track for weekly goals?
- Any fires that need attention?
- Do priorities need to shift?

Friday: Close Out & Reflect

The Weekly Review (45 minutes)

Part 1: Metrics Review (15 min)

- What got done vs. what was planned?
- Key performance indicators status
- Budget/resource utilization

Part 2: Process Improvement (15 min)

- What worked well?
- What didn't work?
- One thing to improve next week

Part 3: Next Week Setup (15 min)

- Preview next week's calendar
- Identify major deliverables

- Prepare Monday's agenda

Weekly Metrics Dashboard

Track these every week without fail:

METRIC	TARGET	ACTUAL	TREND
Revenue	$	$	↑↓→
New Leads	#	#	↑↓→
Customer Issues Resolved	#	#	↑↓→
Employee Satisfaction	1-10	#	↑↓→
Cash Position	$	$	↑↓→

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Metrics That Matter

Track what moves the needle

The Monthly Business Review (MBR)

This is your most important meeting of the month. Schedule 2-3 hours.

Attendees: Leadership team, department heads

Agenda:

1. **Financial Review (30 min)**
   - P&L walkthrough
   - Cash flow analysis
   - Budget vs. actual variance
2. **Operational Metrics (30 min)**
   - KPI dashboard review
   - Department scorecards
   - Process efficiency metrics
3. **Project Status (30 min)**
   - Active projects update
   - Resource allocation
   - Timeline adjustments
4. **People & Culture (20 min)**
   - Hiring needs
   - Team health check
   - Recognition moments
5. **Strategic Initiatives (30 min)**
   - 90-day goal progress
   - Market/competitive updates
   - Strategic pivots if needed
6. **Action Items (10 min)**
   - Clear owners

- Specific deadlines
- Success criteria

Month-End Checklist

Checklist

- [ ] Financial statements reviewed and filed
- [ ] Invoices sent, receivables followed up
- [ ] Payroll processed accurately
- [ ] Tax obligations met
- [ ] Insurance and compliance reviewed
- [ ] Contracts/renewals checked
- [ ] Team 1:1s completed
- [ ] Customer feedback reviewed
- [ ] Process improvements documented
- [ ] Next month goals set

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Implementation Checklist

Your 4-week action plan

SOP Template Structure

Every SOP should follow this format:

```
SOP Title: [Clear, Action-Based Name]
Version: [X.X]
Last Updated: [Date]
Owner: [Role/Name]

PURPOSE
Why does this process exist? What problem does it solve?

SCOPE
Who does this apply to? When is it used?

PREREQUISITES
What needs to be in place before starting?

PROCEDURE
Step 1: [Action verb] [Specific task]
  - Sub-step if needed
  - Notes or warnings

Step 2: [Action verb] [Specific task]
  ...

QUALITY CHECKS
How do we know this was done correctly?

EXCEPTIONS
What variations exist? When to escalate?

RELATED DOCUMENTS
Links to forms, templates, other SOPs
```

Sample SOP: Customer Onboarding

SOP Title: New Customer Onboarding **Version:** 2.1 **Owner:** Customer Success Manager

PURPOSE Ensure every new customer receives consistent, high-quality onboarding that sets them up for success and reduces churn.

PROCEDURE

1. **Send Welcome Email** (within 2 hours of purchase)
    - Use template: "welcome-new-customer-v3"
    - Include: login credentials, next steps, support contact
2. **Schedule Kickoff Call** (within 24 hours)
    - 30-minute video call
    - Agenda: introductions, goals review, platform walkthrough
3. **Complete Account Setup** (before kickoff call)
    - Configure account settings per intake form
    - Import any provided data
    - Enable appropriate features for their tier
4. **Conduct Kickoff Call**
    - Review their specific goals
    - Demonstrate relevant features
    - Set 30-day milestones
    - Schedule follow-up check-in
5. **Send Post-Kickoff Summary** (within 24 hours)
    - Recap key points
    - Link to relevant documentation
    - Confirm next touchpoint
6. **Day 7 Check-In**
    - Automated email + calendar invite for quick call if needed
    - Address any questions or blockers
7. **Day 30 Success Review**
    - Measure against initial goals
    - Identify expansion opportunities
    - Request testimonial if appropriate

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The Documentation Hierarchy

Level 1: **Playbooks** (Strategy & Philosophy)

- Why we do things
- Company values in action
- Decision-making frameworks

Level 2: **SOPs** (Standard Operating Procedures)

- Step-by-step instructions
- Specific processes
- Repeatable tasks

Level 3: **Quick Reference** (Cheat Sheets)

- One-pagers
- Keyboard shortcuts
- Emergency contacts

Writing Effective Documentation

DO:

- Use active voice ("Click the button" not "The button should be clicked")
- Include screenshots for complex steps
- Version everything
- Test procedures with someone unfamiliar
- Schedule regular reviews

DON'T:

- Assume knowledge
- Use jargon without definitions
- Create documentation nobody maintains
- Make it longer than necessary

The 30-Day Documentation Sprint

Week 1: Inventory existing processes Week 2: Document the "fires" (most urgent/frequent) Week 3: Document core operations Week 4: Review, test, and publish

The Operational Scorecard

These are the metrics every operations leader should track:

Efficiency Metrics

- Process cycle time
- First-time quality rate
- Resource utilization
- Cost per transaction

People Metrics

- Employee satisfaction (eNPS)
- Turnover rate
- Training completion rate
- Internal promotion rate

Customer Metrics

- Customer satisfaction (CSAT/NPS)
- Support response time
- Issue resolution time
- Customer effort score

Financial Metrics

- Operating margin
- Revenue per employee
- Cost of goods sold
- Working capital ratio

Building Your Dashboard

Keep it simple. The best dashboards show:

- Current status at a glance
- Trend over time (are we improving?)

- Comparison to target/benchmark
- Clear ownership

Tool recommendations:

- Google Sheets for basics
- Notion for team dashboards
- Power BI/Tableau for advanced analytics

Week 1: Foundation

Checklist

- [ ] Read this entire playbook
- [ ] Identify 3 biggest operational pain points
- [ ] Choose ONE daily habit to implement
- [ ] Set up your metrics tracking system
- [ ] Schedule your first Weekly Review for Friday

Week 2: Daily Rhythm

Checklist

- [ ] Implement the Power Hour routine
- [ ] Establish communication windows
- [ ] Create your personal daily checklist
- [ ] Share framework with team
- [ ] Conduct first Weekly Review

Week 3: Weekly Rhythm

Checklist

- [ ] Hold first Monday Kickoff meeting
- [ ] Establish Wednesday check-in habit
- [ ] Document metrics from Week 2
- [ ] Identify first SOP to create
- [ ] Schedule Monthly Business Review

Week 4: Documentation

Checklist

- [ ] Complete first SOP
- [ ] Establish documentation standards
- [ ] Create quick reference for most common process
- [ ] Review and refine daily/weekly rhythms
- [ ] Celebrate progress with team

Ongoing: Monthly Maintenance

Checklist

- [ ] Conduct Monthly Business Review
- [ ] Update/create 2 SOPs per month
- [ ] Review and archive outdated docs

- [ ] Calibrate metrics and targets
- [ ] Gather team feedback on processes

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Zander helps businesses operate simply. Our consulting and software platform combines hands-on advisory with AI-powered tools to help you build systems that scale.

Learn more: zanderos.com

Need help implementing? Contact us for a Business Analysis session to identify your operational priorities.

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Operating Simply

Zander helps businesses build systems that scale. Our consulting and software platform combines hands-on advisory with AI-powered tools to bring clarity to your operations.

Book a Business Analysis Session

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